Project Report

Widow Support — Food & Financial Aid

Field	Details
Reference	ADA/2022/003
Project Title	Widow Support — Food & Financial Aid
Location	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Period	March 1–31, 2022
Budget	$800 USD (~480,000 CFA)
Actual Spend	$767 USD (~460,000 CFA)
Beneficiaries	15 widows
Team	8 volunteers

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1. Executive Summary

This project was ADA's most comprehensive single-day outreach to date, combining material aid with financial assistance and emotional support for 15 widows in Buea. The initiative successfully established ADA's multi-pronged intervention model, delivering food supplies, household essentials, cash assistance, and companionship through both a community gathering and individual street visits. All 15 targeted beneficiaries were reached, and the project was completed under budget at 460,000 CFA ($767 USD).

2. Activities Implemented

2.1 Preparation Phase

- Identification and verification of 15 widow beneficiaries in Buea.
- Procurement of rice, cooking oil, handbags, plastic buckets, and supplies.
- Preparation of cash envelopes (15 × 3,000 CFA).
- Venue arrangement and logistics coordination.
- Volunteer briefing and role assignment (8 volunteers).

2.2 Community Gathering

- Central gathering organized for beneficiaries in Buea.
- Opening prayer and fellowship session.
- Distribution of complete aid packages to attending widows.
- Group encouragement and community bonding.

2.3 Individual Street Visits

- Door-to-door delivery for widows unable to attend the central gathering.
- Personal companionship and one-on-one encouragement.
- Direct handover of aid packages at beneficiaries' homes.

2.4 Aid Distributed Per Beneficiary

Item	Specification	Quantity
Rice	25kg bag, Thai rice	1
Cooking oil	5L bottle	1
Handbag	New	1
Plastic bucket	With supplies	1
Cash envelope	3,000 CFA	1

3. Results & Outcomes

Indicator	Target	Achieved
Widows reached	15	15 (100%)
Food packages distributed	15	15
Cash envelopes delivered	15	15
Household items distributed	30 (handbags + buckets)	30
Community gathering held	1	1
Volunteers mobilized	8	8

Key Achievements

- **100% beneficiary reach** — All 15 identified widows received comprehensive support.
- **Multi-pronged model established** — Successfully combined material, financial, and emotional support in a single intervention.
- **Under-budget delivery** — Project completed at 460,000 CFA vs. 480,000 CFA budgeted (savings of 20,000 CFA).
- **Community strengthening** — Gathering with prayer fostered social bonds among beneficiaries.
- **Dignified delivery** — Combination of group and individual visits ensured all widows were reached respectfully.

4. Challenges & Lessons Learned

Challenges

- Coordinating logistics for both a central gathering and individual home visits on the same day.
- Ensuring all beneficiaries were informed and available.
- Transporting bulk supplies (25kg rice bags) to individual homes.

Lessons Learned

- The multi-pronged model (food + essentials + cash + companionship) is highly effective and should be replicated.
- Cash envelopes, even at modest amounts, provide beneficiaries with agency to address personal priorities.
- Community gatherings add significant emotional value beyond material distribution.
- A team of 8 volunteers is adequate for serving 15 beneficiaries across both delivery modes.

5. Financial Summary

	Budgeted	Actual
Total	480,000 CFA ($800)	460,000 CFA ($767)
Variance	—	-20,000 CFA (-$33) under budget

Detailed financial breakdown available in the accompanying Financial Report.

6. Recommendations

1. **Scale the model** — Replicate this multi-pronged approach for future widow support projects with larger beneficiary groups.
2. **Increase cash component** — Consider higher cash envelope amounts as beneficiaries reported this as highly impactful.
3. **Follow-up visits** — Schedule 30-day follow-up to assess sustained impact of food supplies.
4. **Document the model** — Formalize the combined material + financial + emotional support approach as ADA's standard intervention framework.

7. Conclusion

The Widow Support — Food & Financial Aid project successfully demonstrated that comprehensive, dignified support can be delivered efficiently within a modest budget. By combining food security, household essentials, direct financial assistance, and emotional companionship, ADA established a replicable model for future community interventions. The project was delivered on time, under budget, and reached 100% of targeted beneficiaries.

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